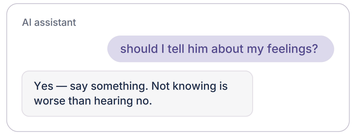
“IT WASN’T ME, IT WAS THE AI”: DECISION DELEGATION AND REGRET

Nick Madibekov, Kate Petrova, James J. Gross
Department of Psychology, Stanford University

BACKGROUND

People hand everyday choices to AI: what to say, what to do. When the AI makes the bad choice, what happens to the regret?



Regret is a counterfactual emotion that arises when an outcome is evaluated as one that would have been better had a different decision been made.

Comparative evaluation
outcome could have been better

Self-blame
the choice was not justified

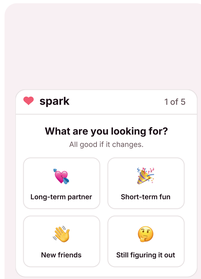
→ **Regret**

If delegating removes self-blame, relying on the AI should protect one from regret after a bad outcome.

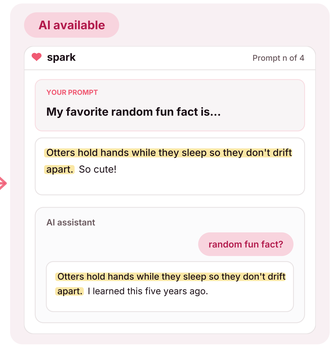
EXPERIMENT

4 trials:
AI available
AI not available
×
Above average
Below average

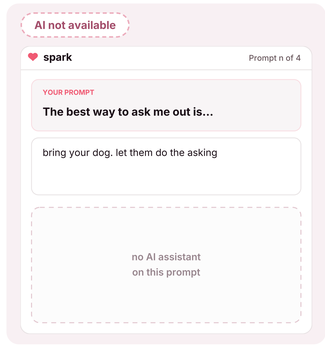
80
Prolific dating app users



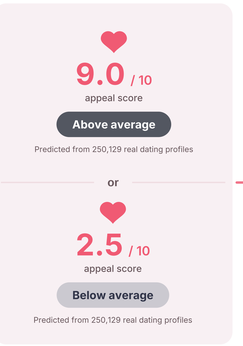
1 Tune the model



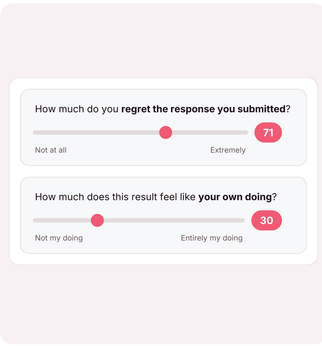
2 Write



3 Outcome

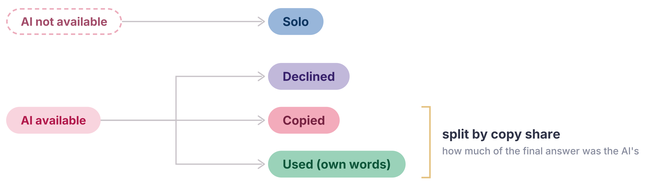


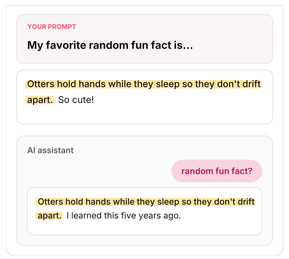
4 Rate

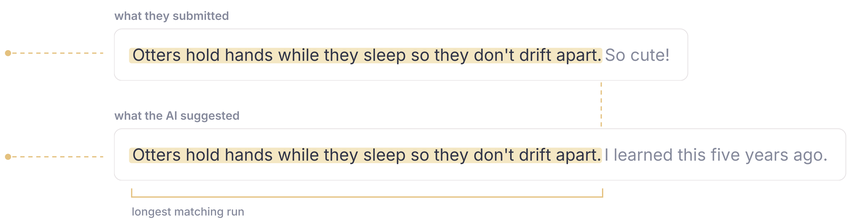


RESULTS

AI reliance







copy share
0.87 61 matched / 70 submitted

≥ 0.60 = Copied
otherwise = Used (own words)

1



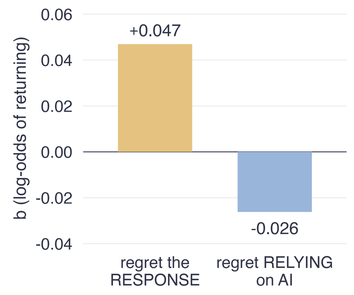
Copying the AI cost people ownership of their results. After a bad outcome it cost them more regret.

2



The more of the answer was the AI's, the more they regretted it and the less they owned the result.

3



On the next trial, regretting the response drives people back to the AI. Regretting the reliance drives them away.

TAKEAWAYS

AI reliance reduces ownership of the outcome, whether it turns out well or badly.

AI reliance raises regret over a bad outcome, rather than softening it.

Outcome regret predicts more AI reliance on the next trial; reliance regret predicts less. What determines which dominates?

REFERENCES

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Zeelenberg, M., van Dijk, W. W., & Manstead, A. S. R. (1998). Reconsidering the relation between regret and responsibility. Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes, 74(3), 254–272.

alikhanm@stanford.edu